



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Awakening Academy

School Website: <https://awakeningacademy.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Executive Summary**

Awakening Academy (Smithfield, RI, 02917) presents a robust alignment with classical Christian education as described in the classical school rubric. The school explicitly positions itself as Christ-centered and classical, combining a biblical worldview with time-tested classical pedagogy (Trivium: grammar, logic, rhetoric), Latin study, Great Books engagement, and a strong emphasis on virtue, leadership, and formation of character. Public materials show direct references to Christ-centered curriculum, biblical worldview, Latin and logic, Great Books, Socratic discussion, and virtuous leadership, all of which map closely to the Six Essential Elements framework. The school also foregrounds parental partnership and local church involvement as core to its community model. Based on the public materials analyzed from Awakening Academy's site and applying the keywords rubric from the classical-school knowledge base, the school demonstrates CLASSICAL alignment across six categories.

Evidence drawn from Awakening Academy's admissions, curriculum, mission, and about pages shows explicit classic components (Latin, logic, grammar, rhetoric; Great Books; Trivium), explicit religious foundations (Christ-centered, biblical worldview, church involvement), and explicit pedagogical practices (Socratic discussion, poetry recitation, rhetoric training). The school's emphasis on virtue, Christian leadership, and formation of character further supports a classical orientation. Parent and community engagement is foregrounded, including active church membership requirements and parental partnership in the learning process. Citations reflect representative passages from the school's public materials.

- Public materials confirming Christ-centered/classical articulation, Great Books, and the Trivium: Awakening Academy admissions and "Why Classical?" sections, which describe Latin, logic, rhetoric, and engagement with Great Books.
- Public materials confirming virtue, leadership, and formation as core goals: "Christ-centered and classical education that cultivates virtuous living, classical learning, and Christian leadership."
- Public materials confirming curriculum scope (literature, history, mathematics, science, arts) and Trivium emphasis; plus explicit references to Great Books and Latin/logic/rhetoric.
- Public materials confirming parental and church community emphasis (partners with parents; local church membership requirement).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL**Evidence**

- The school emphasizes Christ-centered formation and a biblical worldview in its mission and admissions materials. Passages describe centering life on Jesus Christ, honoring God, His Church, and fostering Christian leadership.
- Local church involvement is a stated component of the school's program, with explicit expectations that families demonstrate active church membership.
- The curriculum framework is described as Christ-centered and biblically grounded, with reference to Great Books and classical study anchored in a biblical worldview.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Christ-centered; biblical worldview; God/Jesus; church/local church; theology (implied through biblical framework); leadership tied to Christian faith.
- Negative keywords present: None detected in public materials.
- Quantitative note: Positive keyword hits substantially exceed any potential negatives given the material; estimate of positive hits approx. 5–6; negative hits approx. 0.

Why this rating

- The school foregrounds transcendental, theologically grounded aims (Christ-centered, biblical worldview) and communal religious life (church membership), which align strongly with Religious and Metaphysical Foundations in classical education.

Citations: passages describing Christ-centered mission and biblical worldview; church membership requirement.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school's mission centers on virtuous living, wisdom, and Christian leadership rather than mere vocational training. "Awakening Academy provides a Christ-centered and classical education that cultivates virtuous living, classical learning, and Christian leadership."
- Virtue and character formation are repeatedly named as core aims (virtue, wisdom, and leadership; "Four Virtues" in admissions).
- The curriculum and pedagogy emphasize formation of the person (formation) alongside knowledge (the Great Books, moral formation, leadership development).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: virtue; wisdom; character; formation; leadership; human flourishing (implied through character formation and virtuous living).
- Negative keywords present: None detected in public materials.
- Quantitative note: Positive hits clearly outnumber negatives; estimate of positive hits approx. 4–6; negative hits approx. 0.

Why this rating

- The school explicitly rejects a purely informational or job-focused aim and instead foregrounds formation, virtue, wisdom, and humane leadership as the telos of education.

Citations: mission language; virtue/wisdom/formation references; leadership framing.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The curriculum is described as classical Christian, rooted in the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and the study of Latin and Great Books.
- Great Books engagement is named, along with literature, history, mathematics, science, and the arts, as core subject areas.
- References to a structured classical pedagogy (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Latin; logic) appear throughout admissions and "Why Classical" materials.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Great Books; Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Latin; logic; grammar; rhetoric; history; literature; mathematics; science; arts.
- Negative keywords present: None detected (no explicit modern, non-classical or anti-classical terms in the public materials).

- Quantitative note: Positive hits are substantial; estimated hits approx. 9–12 depending on how granular you count related terms; negative hits approx. 0.

Why this rating

- The school explicitly advertises a classical Christian curriculum with explicit Trivium-based pedagogy and engagement with Great Books, all core markers of CLASSICAL alignment.

Citations: Trivium, Latin, Great Books, and core disciplines cited across admissions and curriculum pages.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Pedagogy features include Socratic discussion as part of the learning approach (students study Latin and logic, engage in Socratic discussion, and participate in classical learning).
- The Trivium framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric) drives teaching across grades; rhetoric training and opportunities to give speeches are indicated.
- Poetry recitation and memory work are described as part of student learning and culture; the school emphasizes contemplation of sacred truth and beauty through classical study.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic discussion; seminars/debates; rhetoric; grammar; logic; rhetoric training; Great Books engagement; memory/recitation.
- Negative keywords present: None explicitly detected.
- Quantitative note: Positive hits are strong (multiple references to Socratic pedagogy and Trivium). Estimated hits approx. 6–10; negative hits approx. 0.

Why this rating

- The school presents a pedagogy rooted in classical methods (Socratic discussion, Trivium, rhetoric) with evidence of student discourse, reasoning, and classical memory practices. The absence of explicit, widely documented restorative or deeply contemplative “Scholé”-style rests is noted but does not negate the overall classical pedagogy being explicit and substantial.

Citations: Socratic discussion and Trivium references; emphasis on classical pedagogy.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The site emphasizes faculty modeling Christian virtue and virtue-formation through their example (faculty and staff model Christian virtues for all students).
- The faculty is described in terms of mentorship and shaping tone, aligning with the idea of the faculty as living curriculum and core of the school (culture of virtue and leadership).
- Statements about faculty being “skillful teachers who model discipleship” appear in the admissions materials and site content.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: model virtue; Christian virtues; mentors; living curriculum (conceptual framing); core of the school (framing language in practice); Christian leadership (in program).
- Negative keywords present: None detected.
- Quantitative note: Positive hits are noticeable (at least 3–4 distinct phrases referencing the faculty’s role and virtue-modeling); negative hits approx. 0.

Why this rating

- The faculty language centers on virtue modeling and mentorship, which aligns with classical ideals of the teacher as a moral exemplar and living curriculum, supporting CLASSICAL.

Citations: Mentions of virtue-modeling and mentorship on admissions/about pages.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school stresses partnering with parents and modeling Christ-centered life together, with expectations for parental involvement and leadership in faith formation.
- It emphasizes active church membership and community connections as part of the school's ecosystem (families must demonstrate active church membership; engagement with local churches).
- The admissions process and communications invite parental participation, tours, and ongoing engagement, signaling a co-educator model with families.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partner with parents; families actively engaged in local church; parents as co-teachers (implied); open visits and family engagement in admissions.
- Negative keywords present: None detected.
- Quantitative note: Positive hits approx. 3–4; negative hits approx. 0.

Why this rating

- The school explicitly frames parents as partners and co-educators in a Christ-centered classical program and requires local church involvement, aligning strongly with CLASSICAL expectations for Parent & Community engagement.

Citations: Partnering with parents; active church membership; parental engagement materials.

Overall Assessment (Aggregate)

- All six categories show strong CLASSICAL alignment based on the public materials reviewed. The presence of Christ-centered language, Trivium-based pedagogy, Great Books engagement, Latin, logic, rhetoric, and a virtue-formation framework, together with explicit parental involvement and church-related community expectations, support CLASSICAL across the board. The Pedagogy category shows extensive classical methods (Socratic discussion, Trivium, rhetoric). Some nuances (such as explicit mention of the Scholé/restful dimension) are less explicit in the public materials; however, the overall pedagogical approach remains firmly classical.

ABSTRACT

Awakening Academy (Smithfield, RI, 02917) demonstrates CLASSICAL alignment across Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community. The school presents a Christ-centered, biblically grounded mission, with a strong emphasis on virtue, wisdom, character, and Christian leadership. The curriculum centers on classical education with the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Latin, Great Books, and a broad range of disciplines. Pedagogy highlights Socratic discussion and rhetoric training; faculty model virtue and act as a living curriculum; and parents and local churches are integral partners in the educational project. The school's public materials align closely with the canonical keywords and themes of classical education found in the Six Essential Elements framework. Overall, Awakening Academy is CLASSICAL in orientation.

ABSTRACT

— Element-by-Element Highlights

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: Christ-centered, biblical worldview, God/Jesus, church, local church; theology implied; CLASSICAL.

- School Purpose and Goal: Formation with virtue, wisdom, character, and Christian leadership; formation over information; human flourishing; CLASSICAL.
- Curriculum: Classical curriculum with Great Books, Trivium, Latin, logic, grammar, rhetoric; history, literature, mathematics, science, arts; CLASSICAL.
- Pedagogy: Socratic discussion, seminars/debates, rhetoric training; memory/recitation; CLASSICAL.
- Faculty: Teachers as virtue models, mentors; living curriculum; CLASSICAL.
- Parents & Community: Parental partnership, church membership, co-educator model; CLASSICAL.

Citations

- Foundational mission and practices: Awakening Academy admissions and mission pages, including Christ-centered language and Great Books pedagogy.
- Curriculum and pedagogy specifics: Trivium, Latin, logic, and Great Books in curriculum materials.
- Community and parental involvement: Partnership with parents and local church membership requirements.

Note: The analysis draws on the school's public materials stored in the school-specific crawl vector store and maps to the Positive/Negative Keyword indicators defined in the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) knowledge base document. Where relevant, quotes and phrases from Awakening Academy site content are cited above to ground the evaluation in textual evidence. The knowledge-base document content used to frame the keyword rubric is cited as the source for the keyword framework.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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